BY ORDER OF THE COMMANDER
JOINT BASE ELMENDORF-RICHARDSON

JOINT BASE ELMENDORF
RICHARDSON INSTRUCTION 36-2502

2 SEPTEMBER 2026

Personnel

SENIOR AIRMAN BELOW-THE-ZONE PROMOTION PROGRAM

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Certified by: 673MSG/CC
(Col Jacob R. Foley)

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This instruction implements Department of the Air Force Policy Directive (DAFPD) 36-25, *Military Promotion and Demotion*, and Air Force Instruction (AFI) 36-2502, *Enlisted Airman Promotion and Demotion Programs*. It provides guidance and policy for the Joint Base Elmendorf-Richardson (JBER), Senior Airman (SrA) Below-the-Zone (BTZ) promotion program and provides administrative procedures for the Central Base Board (CBB) and Large Unit Board (LUB). It applies to all eligible Active-Duty Airman First Class (A1C) members who are assigned to JBER, but does not apply to Air National Guard (ANG) or Air Force Reserve units and members. Submit requests for waivers through the chain of command to the publication Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) for non-tiered compliance items. This instruction cannot be supplemented or further extended. Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the OPR, using Department of the Air Force (DAF) Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Product*. Route the DAF Form 847 through the appropriate chain of command. Ensure all records created as a result of processes prescribed in this publication are maintained in accordance with AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and disposed of in accordance with Air Force Records Information Management System (AFRIMS) Records Disposition Schedule (RDS). The use of the name or mark of any specific manufacturer, commercial product, commodity, or service in this publication does not imply endorsement by the Air Force.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This document addresses administrative changes and formal changes to the 673d Air Base Wing (673 ABW) board process. This document has been revised and should be completely reviewed. Changes include adding decorations and current fitness report to the selection folder contents. 70 percent of the overall score will come from selection folder and the other 30 percent will come from the face-to-face board. Under identifying/verifying eligibles 3.3 deployment was included. Replaced 673 Force Support Squadron Career Development (673FSS/FSPFD) email with 673 Force Support Squadron Promotions email. Removed board minutes and replaced with selection memorandum. Removed Attachment 5. Added the new selection memorandum to **Attachment 2**. **Attachment 4** has been updated with the correct version.

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1. Program Objective. Provide **exceptionally qualified** A1Cs with a one-time consideration for promotion to SrA, to be effective 6 months prior to the fully-qualified point. Selection opportunity is 15 percent.

2. Authorities:

2.1. As the Host Wing Commander, the 673d Air Base Wing Commander (673 ABW/CC) is responsible for administering the BTZ program.

2.2. Commanders of large units (seven or more eligible) have selection and promotion authority. Small unit commanders (six or less eligible) nominate to the CBB and have promotion authority once selections are approved by the respective Wing Commander.

2.3. Commanders of large units may release the results of the LUB and notify the members within their units once they have signed the selection memorandum. Selection memorandum must then be forwarded to the respective Wing Commander for informational purposes only.

3. Identifying/Verifying Eligibles:

3.1. The 673 FSS/FSPFD Element will receive a roster within the first 10 days of the first processing month (January, April, July, October). The roster identifies all A1Cs who meet the Time-In-Grade (TIG) and Time-In-Service (TIS) requirements, regardless of promotion eligibility conditions (that is, on control roster, undergoing Article 15 punishment, referral Enlisted Performance Brief (EPB), and so forth). The 673 FSS/FSPFD will verify each individual to ensure they meet TIG and TIS requirements for the current quarter.

3.2. By the second week of the first processing month (see **Table 1**, below), the 673 FSS/FSPFD will provide Unit CC's an eligibility listing identifying all A1Cs that meet TIG and TIS requirements for those promotion months. Then 673 FSS/FSPFD will coordinate the convening date of the CBB with 673d Air Base Wing Command Chief (673 ABW/CCC).

3.3. Unit commanders must consider all eligible Airmen. This includes individuals who are on leave, Temporary Duty (TDY), deployment or who may have an assignment with a Report No Later Than Date (RNLTD) throughout the quarter prior to the promotion months.

Table 1. Below The Zone (BTZ) Annual Schedule.

Processing Months	*Selection/Board Month*	*Promotion Months*
Jan-Feb	Mar	Apr-Jun
Apr-May	Jun	Jul-Sep
Jul-Aug	Sep	Oct-Dec
Oct-Nov	Dec	Jan-Mar

4. Quotas:

4.1. Quotas are established at 15 percent of eligible individuals based on TIG and TIS only. The 673 FSS/FSPFD determines quotas then distributes to the units/wings. Units may not aggregate at the group level. **Example:** Medical Group is divided into six units and each unit commander has promotion authority, therefore, they will be considered as individual units and cannot be added together to make a large unit (refer to AFI 36-2502, paragraph 2.3.5.1).

4.2. Computation. Eligible Airmen multiplied by 15 percent equals the quota. **Example:** 13 Eligible Airmen X 15% = 1.95 or 2 BTZ Quotas. Fractions of .5 or more are rounded up.

Table 2. Quota Computations and Distribution.

Eligible	*Quota*	*Eligible*	*Quota*
07-09	01	37-43	06
10-16	02	44-49	07
17-23	03	50-56	08
24-29	04	57-63	09
30-36	05	64-69	10

5. Central Base Board (CBB).

5.1. Nomination. Small units (squadrons with six or less eligible) can nominate any eligible A1C in their unit to meet the board. However, it is imperative commanders nominate **only** those Airmen that are **exceptionally qualified** and deserving of early promotion. The board **should not** be asked to consider average packages. Small units are not required to submit a nominee if those eligible are not exceptionally qualified.

5.2. Single Unit Retrieval Format (SURF). The unit will ensure supervisors verify that their nominee's Assignment Management System (AMS) SURF data is accurate and complete. Individuals are responsible for correcting any erroneous data prior to the board convening.

5.3. Board Nomination Format. Units will provide 10 narrative performance statements under the heading ***Specific Accomplishments***, and a fitness comment, single-spaced, on the most current version of the DAF Form 1206, *Nomination for Award* (see **Attachment 4**, of this instruction).

5.3.1. Specific Accomplishments (10 narrative performance statements):

5.3.1.1. Describe significant accomplishments and how well the nominee performed assigned primary and additional duties as well as any community involvement and development efforts they've taken on. Define the scope, level of responsibilities and the impact on the mission and unit. The nomination should capture significant accomplishments and performance from the date entered service to the date of submission.

5.3.1.2. Fitness. Packages must include a **current** fitness report.

5.3.1.3. Decorations. Packages must include all decorations the member has received.

5.3.1.4. Must use approved Air Force acronyms and abbreviations.

5.4. The DAF Form 1206, AMS SURF, fitness report, and all decorations are combined in one portable document format (PDF), no portfolios, and e-mailed to 673d Force Support Squadron Promotions mailbox organizational account.

5.5. All DAF Form 1206s will be scored.

5.6. After selection folder scores are compiled, the candidates will be reduced to twice the number of available stripes, i.e. if 6 stripes are available, then the 12 Airmen with the highest scores will meet the board. In case of a tie at the cut line, all Airmen with that score will meet the board.

5.7. Face-To-Face Board. Finalists will meet a face-to-face board (30 percent of total score), unless unavailable due to TDY, deployment or leave (scheduled prior to board announcement). All absences must be pre-excused/pre-approved by the board president. Members unable to meet the board will receive the average of the compiled scores from the face-to-face board. If 25 percent or more of the members are unavailable, the board will be package only. Exceptions to the face-to-face board process will be made on a case-by-case basis by the 673 ABW/CCC.

5.7.1. The 673 Air Base Wing Command Chief Executive (673 ABW/CCCE), will schedule a face-to-face board and ensure participating units are notified prior to the board convening.

5.7.2. Nominees will be scored on dress and appearance, military bearing, and communication skills. This is the nominee's opportunity to personally communicate their readiness for promotion to the board members.

5.8. Board Composition. The board will consist of the 673 ABW/CCC, or a designee as the board president, and one Chief Master Sergeant (CMSgt) from three to four of the associated units. If there is not a CMSgt available for a specific unit, a Senior Master Sergeant (SMSgt) may act in their stead.

5.9. Selection Folder. The 673 FSS/FSPFD will build an electronic selection folder (70 percent of total score) for each eligible member nominated by their unit commander and upload the BTZ packages per 673 ABW/CCC office instruction no later than one week prior to the face-to-face board. The nominee's selection folder will consist of AMS SURF, DAF Form 1206, **current** fitness report and all decorations. Enlist Performance Review (EPR)/ Enlisted Performance Brief (EPB) and Letters of Evaluation (LOE) **will not** be considered.

5.10. Scoring. Board members will score each nominee's selection folder and face-to-face board using the Management Level Review Scoring Process, a 6-10-point scale in ½-point increments. The board president's scores will only be used in the case of an unresolved tie at the completion of the face-to-face board.

5.10.1. In the event of a package-only board, board members will rank nominees in order of merit. Board members will break their own ties. The total of the board member's order of merit from lowest to highest will determine the members selected.

5.11. Board Recorder. Will collect the score sheets. The 673 ABW/CCCE will act as the board recorder for the CBB and the Military Personnel Flight (MPF) will act as an alternate in absence of the 673 ABW/CCCE.

5.12. Tie. In the event of a tie in points, the board president will direct a reevaluation of the tied packages only. If the matter cannot be resolved, the board president will break the tie.

5.13. Recommendations. The board recorder will provide a promotion recommendation letter for Wing Commander Approval (see **Attachment 2**, this instruction) through the 673 ABW/CCC office. The letter will include a list of board members, board recorder, order of merit (identifying total score and select/non-select status), and cutoff score, and will be signed by the Board President and Recorder.

6. Large Unit Board (LUB).

6.1. Large units are squadrons with seven or more eligible Airmen. Large units may select 15 percent of their eligible individuals for promotion (see **Table 2**, this instruction). If eligible Airmen are not exceptionally qualified for early promotion, unit commanders may elect not to use their full quota.

6.2. The LUB will not be held earlier than the first week of the selection month and no later than the third week of the selection month. This requirement is imposed to ensure fair, equitable, and timely promotion consideration across JBER.

6.3. Supervisors will provide 10 narrative performance statements under the heading ***Specific Accomplishments*** and a fitness comment, single-spaced, on the most current version of the DAF Form 1206 (see **Attachment 4**, this instruction). The one heading is:

6.3.1. Specific Accomplishments (10 narrative performance statements):

6.3.1.1. Describe significant accomplishments and how well the nominee performed assigned primary and additional duties as well as any community involvement and development efforts they've taken on. Define the scope, level of responsibilities and the impact on the mission and unit. The nomination should capture significant accomplishments and performance from the date entered service to the date of submission.

6.3.1.2. The DAF Form 1206, AMS SURF, **current** fitness report and all decorations will be combined into one PDF document and must be e-mailed to the board members from the board president.

6.3.1.3. For approved Air Force Acronyms and Abbreviations please reference the list that is posted in myFSS.

6.3.1.4. Fitness. Packages must include a **current** fitness report.

6.3.1.5. Decorations. Packages must include all decorations the member has received.

6.4. The LUB will have a board president and three to four board members. The LUB will consist of the squadron Senior Enlisted Leader or designee, who will serve as board president. All other CMSgts in the unit should be given the opportunity to participate in the LUB. The board president may also identify SMSgt, and if necessary, Master Sergeants (MSgt), from the unit as board members to ensure a wide cross-section of the unit is represented. MSgts will only be used as board members if CMSgts or SMSgts are not available. CMSgts and SMSgts from other units may be used.

6.5. The package will consist of the AMS SURF, DAF Form 1206, current fitness RIP and decorations. EPRs/EPBs and LOEs **will not** be considered.

6.6. Commanders of large units will determine whether to hold a face-to-face board or not, but **a face-to-face board is highly encouraged for the sake of fairness between the CBB and LUB processes**.

6.6.1. If a face-to-face board is held, scoring, rank ordering and final promotion recommendations will be conducted in the same manner as the CBB. See **paragraph 5.8** thru **paragraph 5.12** in this instruction.

6.6.1.1. At the unit commander's discretion, large units may elect to have all eligible members meet the face-to-face board via electronic means.

6.6.2. Large units that decide not to hold face-to-face boards will establish an order of merit solely based off the submitted packages (100% of score).

6.7. Upon identifying the unit selectees, the unit will then provide selection memorandum (see **Attachment 3**, this instruction) and signed (digital or appropriate signature) unit roster to the 673 FSS Promotions e-mail account by the suspense date coordinated by the Enlisted Promotions Technician.

6.8. A board report containing a list of board members, board recorder, order of merit (identifying total score and select/non-select status), and cutoff score will be accomplished. Report will be signed by the Board President and Recorder, forwarded to the Unit Commander for approval signature, and filed for record.

7. Announcing Selection:

7.1. Results of the CBB will be released by the 673 ABW/CC via the 673 ABW/CCC once the selection memorandum is signed.

7.2. Results of unit level boards will be released once the selection memorandum is signed by the respective commander.

7.3. The 673 FSS/FSPFD will update the projected promotion within 48 hours after receipt of the signed memorandum.

JACOB R. FOLEY, Colonel, USAF
Commander

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

DAFPD 36-25, *Military Promotion and Demotion*, 15 December 2022

AFI 36-2502, *Enlisted Airman Promotion and Demotion Programs*, IC1, 14 August 2025

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, 23 March 2020

Prescribed Forms

None

Adopted Forms

DAF Form 847, *Recommendation for Change of Product*

DAF Form 1206, *Nomination for Award*

Abbreviations and Acronyms

A1C—Airman First Class

ABW—Air Base Wing

AF—Air Force

AFI—Air Force Instruction

AFRIMS—Air Force Records Information Management System

ANG—Air National Guard

AMS—Assignment Management System

BTZ—Below-the-Zone

CBB—Central Base Board

CMSgt—Chief Master Sergeant

DAF—Department of the Air Force

DAFPD—Department of the Air Force Policy Directive

EPB—Enlisted Performance Brief

EPR—Enlisted Performance Report

JBER—Joint Base Elmendorf-Richardson

LOE—Letter of Evaluation

LUB—Large Unit Board

MPF—Military Personnel Flight

MSgt—Master Sergeant

OPR—Office of Primary Responsibility

PDF—Portable Document Format

RNLTD—Report No Later Than Date

SMSgt—Senior Master Sergeant

SrA—Senior Airman

SURF—Single Unit Retrieval Format

TDY—Temporary Duty

TIG—Time-in-Grade

TIS—Time-in-Service

Office Symbols

673 ABW—673d Air Base Wing

673 ABW/CC—673d Air Base Wing Commander

673 ABW/CCC—673d Air Base Wing Command Chief

673 ABW/CCCE—673d Air Base Wing Command Chief Executive

673 FSS/FSPFD—673d Force Support Squadron Career Development Section

673 FSS—673d Force Support Squadron

Attachment 2

SAMPLE CBB BOARD PROMOTION RECOMMENDATION LETTER

Figure A2.1. Sample 673 ABW BTZ Promotion Recommendation Letter.

DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
673D AIR BASE WING (PACAF)
JOINT BASE ELMENDORF-RICHARDSON, ALASKA

DD Month YYYY

MEMORANDUM FOR 673 ABW/CC

FROM: 673 ABW/CCC

SUBJECT: Senior Airman Below-the-Zone Promotion Recommendation

1. The 673d Air Base Wing Senior Airman Below-the-Zone Promotion Central Base Board for the XX quarter of FY 202X convened on DD Month YYYY, with the following board members:

Rank / Name	Org / Office Symbol	Board Position
Rank/Name		President
Rank/Name		Member
Rank/Name		Member
Rank/Name		Member
Rank/Name		Member
Rank/Name	673 ABW/CCCE	Recorder

2. The board considered XX candidates, and a quota of number (#) stripes to award. Candidates' selection folders were scored, and added to their face-to-face board scores for the total amount represented in the table below. The board's recommendation is summarized by order of merit below, with cut-off indicated by the heavy line below the last selectee:

Merit	Name (Last, First)	Org	Score	Status	Promo Date
1				Selected	DD Month YYYY
8				Alternate 1	
10				Not Selected	

FIRST MI. LAST, CMSgt, USAF
Board President

1st Ind to 673 ABW/CC, DD Month YYYY, Senior Airman Below-the-Zone Promotion Recommendation

673 ABW/CCCE

MEMORANDUM FOR 673 ABW/CC

Concur / ~~Non-concur~~

FIRST MI. LAST, SSgt, USAF
Board Recorder

2d Ind, 673 ABW/CC

MEMORANDUM FOR 673 FSS/FSMPD

Approved / ~~Disapproved~~

FIRST MI. LAST, Colonel, USAF
Commander

Attachment 3

SAMPLE LARGE UNIT BTZ BOARD MINUTES AND RECOMMENDATION LETTER

Figure A3.1. Sample Large Unit BTZ Promotion Recommendation Letter.

MEMORANDUM FOR 673 FSS/FSMPD

FROM: (Unit/Office Symbol of Board President)

SUBJECT: Senior Airman Below-the-Zone Promotion Recommendation

1. The _____ Large Unit Senior Airman Below-the-Zone Promotion Board for the ____ quarter of FY _____ convened on (date) in building _____.

Board members were:

Grade/Name	Organization/Office Symbol	Position
XXXXXXXXX	XXXXXXXXX	Board President
XXXXXXXXX	XXXXXXXXX	Board Member
XXXXXXXXX	XXXXXXXXX	Board Member
XXXXXXXXX	XXXXXXXXX	Board Member
XXXXXXXXX	XXXXXXXXX	Board Member

2. The board considered ____ nominees. The board had a quota of ____ selectees. The board's recommendation is summarized below.

Name (Last, First, MI)	Organization	Promotion Date
XXXXXXXXXXX	XXXXXX	DD-MMM-YY
XXXXXXXXXXX	XXXXXX	DD-MMM-YY

_____
Board President

1st Ind to(Unit/OFF SYM of board president), (Date from front side), Senior Airman Below-the-Zone Promotion Recommendation

MEMORANDUM FOR 673 FSS/FSPFD

Approved/Disapproved

Unit Commander Signature Block
Commander

cc:
673 ABW/CCCE

Attachment 4

SAMPLE DAF FORM 1206 FOR BTZ

Figure A4.1. Sample DAF Form 1206 for BTZ.

NOMINATION FOR AWARD

AWARD	CATEGORY (If Applicable)	AWARD PERIOD
Senior Airman Below-the-Zone	BTZ	FY1Q

RANK/NAME OF NOMINEE (First, Middle Initial, Last)	MAJCOM, FLDCOM, FOA OR DRU
A1C/John E. Doe	PACAF

DAFSC/DUTY TITLE	NOMINEE'S TELEPHONE (DSN & Commercial)
3E032/Electrical Power Production Journeyman	DSN: 317-384-2222 & Commmercial: 907-384-2222

UNIT/OFFICE SYMBOL/STREET ADDRESS/BASE/STATE/ZIP CODE
Unit/Address/Joint Base Elmendorf-Richardson, AK 99506

RANK/NAME OF UNIT COMMANDER (First, Middle Initial, Last)/COMMANDER'S TELEPHONE (DSN & Commercial)
Col/Jane E. Doe/DSN: (XXX)XXX-XXXX & COMMERCIAL: (XXX) XXX-XXXX

SPECIFIC ACCOMPLISHMENTS (Use Performance Statements IAW DAFMAN 36-2806)

Specific Accomplishments:

- Limit to 10 narrative statements/2 lines per statement/total of 20, not including the header, this is the length of the 1206, do not include acronyms.

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- Limit to 10 narrative statements/2 lines per statement/total of 20, not including the header, this is the length of the 1206, do not include acronyms.

- Nomination packages (DAF Form 1206) should encompass the Airman's career including accomplishments from BMT, technical training, upgrade training, and other certifications.

- Well rounded nomination packages should include performance in primary duties, personal/professional development, and community involvement.

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